

Americas Banks: Key Takeaways from TFC, FITB, and RF earnings

TFC: Expecting a ~14%+ ROTCE in 2026; sees ~10% fee growth in 2026

TFC reported decent 2Q26 results as core PPNR came in ahead of street (Visible Alpha Consensus Data) expectations as lower NII was more than offset by higher fees and lower expenses (incl. adj. for NQDCP). On credit, NCOs came in lower than expectations (50bps. vs. cons of 55bps) which along with a lower provision helped to drive the EPS beat. The focus was on TFC's updated 2026 / 3Q26 outlook, which pointed to lower revenues for 2026 (+3.5 -4%, down from ~4%) and a lower 3Q guide (~1% downside to street PPNR) largely on higher expenses and implies moderate PPNR improvement in 4Q (~2% downside vs. street). The downside to FY PPNR was largely on lower NII where TFC sees lesser improvement vs. prior expectations (had expected modestly up for full-year now guide implies flat to down) while TFC took up its fee income expectations to +10% YoY (vs. HSD prior). Additionally, TFC laid out a plan for some balance sheet optimization where it expects lower production in indirect auto while shutting down marine and RV lending given a focus on improving profitability and while it continues to expect loan growth of +3-4% (high-end) it sees flat to 1% growth in consumer with the rest coming from commercial (largely C&I). Lastly, TFC slightly refined its 2026 ROTCE expectations where it now expects a ~14%+ ROTCE vs. ~14% prior.

Shares were in-line (-1.41% vs. KRE -1.58%) as the market digested the results and lower guidance. Looking ahead while guide was mixed, we believe positioning was negative on concerns of the risk of TFC lowering guidance. Now that it happened, we walk away somewhat upbeat on the fundamentals from here, as: 1) despite the softer NII message from a lower NIM (tighter loan spreads, swaps coming on, lower betas), TFC is seeing stronger fee income growth as it noted expectations for ~10% YoY growth (likely led by IBD and trading) and with an improved fee mix for the year this should help support the >14% ROTCE expectation even further, 2) loan growth was soft in 2Q given a decline in C&I as well as the planned reductions in indirect portfolios; however, the constructive backdrop for commercial lending should allow TFC to reach the high-end of its loan growth guide in 2026 (2Q EOP implies 4% growth already). Additionally, while the guidance implies shrinking consumer loans on an EOP basis, the reduction in lower-returning loans should be accretive to its ROTCE given a) an ability to payoff high-cost funding, b) a higher mix of commercial lending which is likely higher-returning, 3) the message on ROTCE for 2026 was positive, with TFC taking up expectations to ~14%+ (vs. ~14% prior) despite the NII headwinds and while commentary on the call pointed to expectations for continued ROTCE improvement in 2027 / 2028, TFC's message on retaining the right of

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flexibility to achieve its ROTCE goals likely provides a path for its new CEO to make adjustments to the timing of when its 16-18% ROTCE goal can be achieved. With shares trading at ~1.6x P/TBV (peers at 1.8x), the market believes that profitability will continue to lag peers though with numbers likely in a better place for 2026, we think performance from here will come down to what the incoming CEO's message is on return expectations for 2027+. Therefore, if TFC is able to deliver on improving returns in 2027, shares should have meaningful upside over time.

Exhibit 1: TFC guidance summary

2026 Guidance Table			
	TFC		
	3Q26	2026	Medium/Long-term
NII	- NII expected to increase 1% driven by an additional day and higher client deposit balances - Expect NIM to modestly improve throughout the year via fixed-asset repricing	- NII expected to grow 1-1.5% from a baseline of \$14.6bn - Expect swaps for 3Q/4Q of \$100mn/over \$100mn - \$42bn of loans rolling off at 6.43% (6.90% roll-on yield) - \$15bn of securities rolling off a 3.76%	- Make progress in 2026 towards the 3 teens NIM number have talked about and hope to get there in 2027 - Expect 3.5-4%+ revenue growth in 2026 driven by NII growth, NIM expansion, and fees (QTD Update)
Fee Income	- Non-interest income to decline 1% from baseline of \$1.56bn implying \$1.54bn - Expect stable revenue in 2Q	- 10% growth in Non-interest income - Expect TM to grow LDD - Expect to grow IB LDD	- Expect capital markets to grow at LDD CAGR over time
Total Revenues	- Expect revenue to increase ~1%	- Expect revenues to increase 3.5-4%	
Expenses	- Expenses expected to increase ~2% due to higher personnel expense from a baseline of \$3.1bn implying \$3.2bn in 2Q	- Expect expenses to grow 1.75% from a baseline of \$12.1bn implying \$12.3bn - Expect 275bps of positive operating leverage (GAAP) - Expect lower severance	- Expect to continue to grow OL
Balance sheet		- Expect LSD EOP deposit growth - Expect LSD EOP loan growth - Expect average loans to grow 3-4% with the bulk coming from C&I and consumer up 1% - Loan growth to be more wholesale driven vs consumer - AEA will grow at slower rate through the year than average loans as average investment securities are expected to decline by 4-5% - Loan spreads expected down 5-10bps yoy - Expect auto and mortgage loans growth to slow or be flat - Deposit mix to be closer to 25% by the end of the year.	
Credit		- NCOs are expected to be ~55bps - Do not expect reserve releases	
Capital	- Targeting \$1.2bn in share repurchases	- Targeting \$5bn in share repurchases - Expect greater than 14% ROTCE - Expect dividend payout 30-40%, 30-40% buybacks, and leaving the rest to grow	- Targeting 15% ROTCE in 2027; 16-18% Long term - Trend towards 10% CET1 by 4Q27
Tax rate		- 14.5% effective, 16.5% FTE	

Note: Expense guidance will be GAAP moving forward

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

FITB: Expense synergies tracking better than expected; signals upside to 2027 loan expectations

FITB reported decent 2Q26 results as a slight PPNR beat was driven by core fees coming in modestly higher than expected while core expenses were lower while NII was in-line (in-line NIM and AEA). Provisions came in lower than expected and NCOs were a touch lower helping to drive the EPS beat. The focus was on FITB's 3Q / updated 2026 outlook which pointed to slight PPNR downside in 3Q due to the timing of cost saves and upside in 4Q along with updates on the progress of the merger where FITB pointed to consumer deposit campaign outperformance (\$2.5bn of growth; \$1bn initially expected), expense synergies tracking ahead of its initial \$850mn expectations (with upside potentially reinvested), and reiterated expectations for a Labor Day systems conversion with the remainder of expense synergies pulling through in 4Q.

Shares underperformed (-2.29% vs. KRE -1.58%) as the market digested the EPS beat along with somewhat upbeat guidance. We think the underperformance was driven by the softer PPNR outlook in 3Q26 (though we note the higher expenses is timing related), and it should see performance improve into 4Q with potential upside (which it may choose to reinvest). Looking ahead, the CMA integration appears to be tracking as planned or better (even posted 1% loan growth after 3-4 years of stability) and while the PPNR guidance has some moving pieces in 3Q it should improve by 4Q positioning FITB to deliver efficiency in the 51-52% range for the quarter (and 53% or lower next year). Given that, we remain upbeat on fundamentals, as: 1) EOP loans outperformed, with legacy FITB C&I growing ~2% QoQ while CMA C&I grew ~1% and FITB noted it expects the growth it saw to be sustainable (ex-macro changes). Post the conversion, FITB expects an acceleration in growth led by the CMA franchise (we model ~1.5% quarterly in '27) and with the street (Visible Alpha) looking for ~4% EOP loan growth in 2027 we think there is upside to 2027 growth expectations, 2) FITB noted it saw its Southwest and CA deposit campaign outperform expectations (\$2.5bn of growth vs. \$1bn of expectations) and while campaign promos typically come on at a higher cost, FITB noted it expects deposit costs to be stable to slightly up in a flat rate environment which should allow it to fund the stronger loan growth (particularly in 2027) it is expecting without diluting margin / returns, 3) the message on returns / growth was positive, with FITB continuing to expect to deliver a 51-52% efficiency in 4Q26 and a ~19%+ ROTCE in 2027 with incremental profitability from synergies / growth supporting investments in the business which should allow FITB to sustain a higher than peer TBV multiple (given its ROTCE) along with accelerating TBV growth which should support shares over the medium-term. While shares are trading at 11.6x our 2027E, a premium to peers at 10.8x, we believe it is due to the market's confidence in the momentum of the CMA transaction and ability to sustain peer-leading returns / TBV growth, and as FITB continues to deliver on the integration as well as execute on its medium-term targets, shares should have further upside over time.

Exhibit 2: FITB guidance summary

2026 Guidance Table			
	3Q26	FITB	2026
			Medium/Long-term
NII	- Nil growth of 2-2.5% driven by extra days and fixed rate repricing - Forward curve expect hike in September - Deposit costs stable to slightly up even in a flat fed funds world - A hike would see asset-side repricing outweigh deposit costs, benefiting NII	- NII guided to \$8.74-\$8.80bn for FY, assumes 12/31/31 fed rate of 4.00% - Normalized margin expected to move into the 3.40s sometime next year. - Exit-2026 profitability and efficiency to align with (and likely beat) 2027 targets	- Expect receive-fixed swap rate of 3.44% by YE31 with notional value of \$5bn (current 3.28%) - Deposit growth to remain MSD in long term
Fee Income	- Adj. noninterest income expected to grow by 1-3%	- Expected between \$4.06-\$4.16bn	- Capital markets mid to HSD growth business in the LT
Total Revenues	- Guidance implied adj. revenue up by ~2% and PPNR up by ~7%	- Guidance implies adj. revenue at \$12.9bn and PPNR at \$5.6bn	
Expenses	- Expenses to trend down between 1-2%; included impact of anticipated amortization - 4Q is seasonally most efficient, so results should beat 53% efficiency	- Guided to \$7.22-\$7.26bn - The \$850 mn of savings figure is unchanged - On track to open 55 branches this year	- To have 600 branches by YE28 - Will add 150 branches to CMA's Texas footprint
Balance sheet	- MSD deposit growth is sustainable and can accelerate with marketing, supporting MSD loan growth	- Avg. loans to grow to \$174-\$176bn implying 2% growth in 2H - Loan growth is sustainable barring a macro change, with broad confidence aided by Middle East de-escalation and settled tariff confusion. - For deposits 2H has seasonality with a 4Q ramp as commercial builds. - Growth accelerated and should not decelerate; legacy C&I up over 2%, Comerica up 1% from flat, all production-driven. - Same-platform migration post conversion should accelerate blended C&I growth.	- 2026 solar originations down 70-80% from 2025; don't see till stabilization until 2028 - Four \$10 bn opportunities frame a \$40 bn total over five to seven years: Southeast, Southwest, small business, and tech and life sciences.
Credit	- 2H net charge-offs of 30-35 bps	- NCO ratio between 30-40bps	
Capital	- Buybacks resume in 2H - 3Q buybacks smaller given deal charges (~\$50 mn-\$100 mn) and loan growth dependency.	- Near term CET1 of 10.5% - Expect preferred dividend schedule to be at ~\$32 in 4Q - 4Q back to normalized pacing of \$200 mn-\$300 mn per quarter. - 4Q is seasonally most efficient, so results should beat 19% ROTCE	- Expect AOCI accretion of ~19%/-41% (~\$0.34-\$1bn) by YE26/YE28 - Expect TBV to improve by +3%/+2%/+2% by YE26/27/28 from AOCI accretion assuming 10Y UST to be at 4.8% by YE28
Taxes	- Effective tax rate of 22.5%	- Effective tax rate of 22-23%	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

RF: Expecting stable deposit costs from here; NIM headed to 3.70% (with further upside over time)

RF reported decent 2Q26 results as PPNR was largely in-line (touch higher NII, higher fees offset by higher expenses) while the EPS beat was driven by stronger credit as lower

NCOs (42bps vs. street (Visible Alpha) of 47bps) and a reserve release. The focus was on its outlook where RF tweaked its fee guide to the low end of the 3-5% growth given softer capital markets activity, while leaving the rest of the outlook unchanged. The outlook implies 2H PPNR that is relatively in-line with street expectations. For 3Q (and implied 4Q), it pointed to NII up ~2% QoQ with a stable to modestly higher NIM in 3Q (vs 3.66% in 2Q) with an exit rate of 3.70% for YE26 which implied modestly stronger AEA trends. Additionally, within that it expects deposit costs to remain largely flat and noted that the margin should have a further upward bias over time driven by fixed rate re-pricing.

Shares underperformed (-2.31% vs. -1.58% for KRE) as the market digested the results and updated message. We are uncertain what drove the underperformance as positioning was negative coming in and the results were decent. Some pointed to a lower fee guide without signaling lower expenses (which tend to be linked) while others we spoke with cited the slower buyback. Looking ahead, while this was not an inflection quarter (more consistent), we come out reasonably upbeat on fundamentals, as: 1) despite fears of increasing competition for deposits in the Southeast, RF was able to hold lower deposit costs to 1.69% (from 1.72% in 1Q) and expects continued stability through year-end despite a lower benefit from CD repricing (roll-on roll-off rates now in-line) which should help support its expectations for margin expansion over time, 2) loan growth in 2Q was solid, with EOP increasing ~1.3% and while the first half benefited from line draws that RF does not expect to re-occur, it kept its average growth guide unchanged and we think the guide could prove conservative as 2Q's average loans are already up 3% vs. 2025's average and even with a little slower growth it should be well positioned for MSD+ growth in 2027, 3) the message on credit was solid, with losses in the quarter outperforming expectations and RF's guidance implying a low 40bps NCO rate in 2H (vs. expectations for mid-40s) which along with a ~3% QoQ decline in NPAs is supportive of RF's commentary that credit has largely normalized. Additionally, while RF didn't confirm this view, it recognized that losses could fall below 40bps given how well problem assets have been worked out and what the new pipelines look like (said it's being actively debated). Post results, shares trade at 11.1x our 2027E vs. peers at 11.0x. We believe if RF shows improving and sustainable balance sheet growth throughout in 2H26 and maintains peer-leading funding costs and returns, it should see further upside to shares over time.

Exhibit 3: RF guidance summary

2026 Guidance Table			
		RF	
	3Q26	2026	Medium/Long-term
NII	- Expect NII to increase 2%, progressing towards the middle of the FY guidance - 3Q NIM to be flat to slightly up	- Expect NII to be up 2.5-4% from a baseline of \$4.99bn implying \$5.15bn - NIM expectation assumes a mid-30% beta and low single-digit loan growth - 4Q26 exit NIM to be ~3.70s - Deposit costs to remain stable over 2H, assuming constant FF rate - Interest-bearing deposit beta expected to remain at mid-30s to the extent the Fed moves rates.	- Expect receive-fixed rate on cash flow swaps to increase to 3.60% by 2031 from 3.01% in 2025 - Confident in resilient NIM no matter the rate environment - Remain modestly asset sensitive to medium and long term rate changes - Expect fixed rate repricing benefit for a couple years (QTD Update)
Fee Income	- Expect quarterly capital markets revenue to be on the lower end of the range of \$90-105mn in 3Q with momentum building thereafter - Wealth management to showing continued strength	- Expect fee income to be on lower end of 3-5% range from a baseline of \$2.59bn implying \$2.69bn - Expect to continue to drive growth in wealth business from production and favorable market conditions - Card and ATM fees to be moderate in 2H	- Want to drive Fee income to higher % of revenue over LT - Expect capital markets to be a \$400mn business overtime
Expenses		- Adjusted non-interest expenses to be up 1.5-3.5% from a baseline of \$4.33bn implying \$4.44bn - Expect FY positive operating leverage	- Continue to invest in talent across the footprint in key areas over the next 3 years - 10-12% tech spend target - Plan to build 135-150 branches over next 5 years
Balance sheet		- Average loans to be up LSD from a baseline of \$96.1bn implying \$98.5bn - Growing loan commitments 2-2.5% a year - Do not expect portfolio reshaping headwind compared to 2025 - believe most of it has been worked through - Average deposits to be up LSD from a baseline of \$129.2bn implying \$132.4bn	- Over long term expect to grow loans as real GDP plus a little bit - next year real GDP growth expectations of (2%)
Credit		- Expect NCOs of 0.40-0.50%	- Allowance could return to Day 1 CECL levels (1.63%) - it is moving towards it
Capital	- 3Q buybacks to pick up a bit	- Expect ~\$167mn of AOCI burndown by YE26 - Expect CET1 (inclusive of AOCI) to be around the midpoint of 9.25-9.75% in the near term	- Expect ~\$167mn of AOCI burndown by YE27 - LT ROTCE target is 16-18%, can get to 18-20% adj. for AOCI
Tax rate		- Tax rate in 20.5-21.5% range	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation:

TFC (Buy): We are Buy rated on TFC with a 12-month \$59 price target based on 11.5x 2027 P/E multiple. Key risks include greater than expected expenses, deposit outflows and higher than anticipated credit losses.

FITB (Buy): We are Buy rated on FITB with a 12-month \$66 price target based on 13.0x 2027 P/E multiple. We revise our 2026 core EPS estimate to \$4.20 and we revise our 2027 core EPS estimate to \$5.05 from \$5.00 and our 2028 core EPS estimate to \$5.55 from \$5.60 reflecting updated guidance and our updated views on capital markets, expenses, and NII. Key downside risks include slower than expected realization of expense synergies which would weigh on profitability, slower than expected loan growth if FITB is not able to drive growth in the legacy Comerica commercial business, and a faster than expected pace of benchmark rate declines given the proforma asset sensitivity profile of the bank.

RF (Buy): We are Buy-rated on RF with a 12-month \$36 price target based on a multiple of ~12.5x 2027 P/E driven by our updated thoughts on revenue and margin. We maintain our 2026 core EPS estimate of \$2.60 and we revise our 2027 core EPS estimate to \$2.80 from \$2.85 and our 2028 core EPS estimate to \$3.10 from \$3.15 reflecting updated guidance and our updated views on capital markets, expenses, and NII. Key risks include lower than expected deposit betas, sustained negative operating leverage and credit deterioration.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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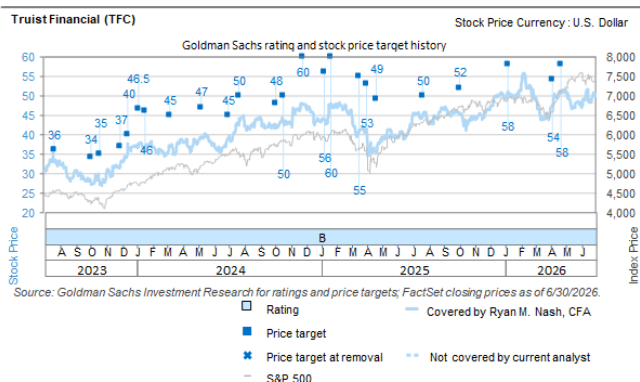
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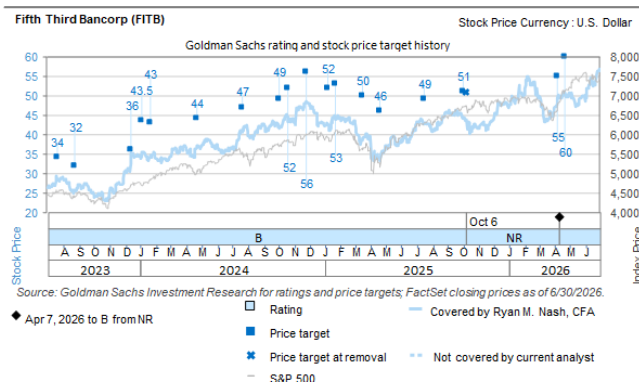
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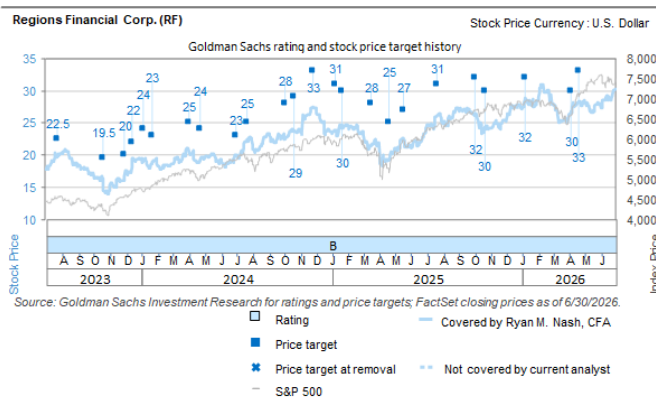
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Target price history table(s)

Truist Financial (TFC)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
06-Jul-26	59.00	51.42
22-Apr-26	58.00	50.95
06-Apr-26	54.00	47.64
06-Jan-26	58.00	51.18
03-Oct-25	52.00	45.52
21-Jul-25	50.00	44.73
21-Apr-25	49.00	35.31
01-Apr-25	53.00	41.02
17-Mar-25	55.00	41.05
21-Jan-25	60.00	47.89
07-Jan-25	56.00	43.97

Regions Financial Corp. (RF)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
06-Jul-26	36.00	30.48
20-Apr-26	33.00	28.31
06-Apr-26	30.00	26.74
06-Jan-26	32.00	28.71
21-Oct-25	30.00	24.36
03-Oct-25	32.00	26.39
21-Jul-25	31.00	26.05
19-May-25	27.00	22.54
21-Apr-25	25.00	19.09
17-Mar-25	28.00	21.54
21-Jan-25	30.00	24.65

Truist Financial (TFC)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
25-Nov-24	60.00	48.10
18-Oct-24	50.00	43.67
02-Oct-24	48.00	41.77
23-Jul-24	50.00	44.15
01-Jul-24	45.00	39.25
07-May-24	47.00	39.11
07-Mar-24	45.00	36.92
19-Jan-24	46.00	37.47
04-Jan-24	46.50	36.97
16-Dec-23	40.00	36.70
30-Nov-23	37.00	32.14
20-Oct-23	35.00	27.16
02-Oct-23	34.00	27.63
21-Jul-23	36.00	33.05

Regions Financial Corp. (RF)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
07-Jan-25	31.00	23.85
25-Nov-24	33.00	27.47
21-Oct-24	29.00	23.63
02-Oct-24	28.00	22.56
22-Jul-24	25.00	22.39
01-Jul-24	23.00	19.90
22-Apr-24	24.00	19.18
01-Apr-24	25.00	20.56
22-Jan-24	23.00	19.07
04-Jan-24	24.00	18.97
16-Dec-23	22.00	19.53
30-Nov-23	20.00	16.68
21-Oct-23	19.50	14.44
24-Jul-23	22.50	20.00

Fifth Third Bancorp (FITB)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
06-Jul-26	66.00	57.89
22-Apr-26	60.00	50.56
07-Apr-26	55.00	47.79
03-Oct-25	51.00	44.41
18-Jul-25	49.00	43.03
21-Apr-25	46.00	33.32
17-Mar-25	50.00	38.99
22-Jan-25	53.00	43.93
07-Jan-25	52.00	42.86
25-Nov-24	56.00	48.44
21-Oct-24	52.00	43.37
02-Oct-24	49.00	41.98
22-Jul-24	47.00	40.86
22-Apr-24	44.00	36.55
22-Jan-24	43.00	34.56
04-Jan-24	43.50	34.42
16-Dec-23	36.00	35.03
25-Aug-23	32.00	25.42
21-Jul-23	34.00	28.23

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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